9.16 Spinal Fusion*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Back pain 7/10 **Objective** • Posterior spinal incision • Guarding	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to spinal surgery as evidenced by pain score.	• Pain at or below 3/10 within 24 hours.	• Give PCA or regular analgesia as prescribed. • Log-roll for every change of position. • Assess pain regularly.	• Outcome reached when pain is controlled.
Subjective • "How do I get out of bed?" **Objective** • Brace ordered • Cannot describe a safe transfer	**ACTUAL** Inadequate health knowledge related to spinal precautions as evidenced by questioning.	• Gets in and out of bed safely.	• Teach log-rolling and rising from lying on the side. • Teach how to put the brace on correctly. • Advise against bending, lifting and twisting.	• Considered met when demonstrated.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Spinal surgery • L4–L5 decompression	**RISK** Risk for impaired peripheral neurovascular function as evidenced by risk factors: spinal surgery.	• Normal limb function.	• Check leg movement and sensation regularly. • Report any new weakness.	• Goal reached if function stays normal.

* **References for this care plan:** [14], [32], [35], [76]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.